

Opposition is control of entry

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

Kings facing one another with one square between them create direct opposition. The side not to move often benefits because the other king must yield ground. The value depends on pawns, board edges, and the squares each side wants to enter.

WORKED EXAMPLE

White king e4 and Black king e6 have e5 between them. If Black must move, White may gain access to d5 or f5, depending on Black's choice and the rest of the board. If White must move, the roles reverse.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Why is opposition a tool rather than the goal itself?

ANSWER AND REASONING

You want access to critical squares or to prevent the opponent's access. Winning a geometric opposition that leads nowhere useful may waste time or allow a pawn break.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Use opposition to win a square that matters.